

THE NEW STRATEGIC SYNERGY

PM MODI'S FIRST VISIT TO THE RSS HEADQUARTERS IN A DECADE ENDED TALK OF THE BJP'S RIFT WITH ITS MENTOR AND SHOWCASED A RENEWED MARCH TOWARDS SHARED GOALS

By **ANILESH S. MAHAJAN**

On March 30, Prime Minister Narendra Modi was in Nagpur, visiting the headquarters of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), his first visit since he took over as the prime minister of India in 2014. Visuals of him and sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat paying homage at the Dr Hedgewar Smruti Mandir in Nagpur dominated the news, which was significant as it laid to rest any speculation of a rift between the BJP and its ideological parent.

The last detail had been hanging fire since BJP president J.P. Nadda's comment last May that seemed to suggest that the party had outgrown the RSS. The consequences of that, the reverses in the general election, the patch-up efforts, the